



STATUS REPORT

Cote d'Ivoire — digital transformation and data governance status report

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The strategy that governs Ivorian digital policy has aged out from under the machine that keeps producing new ones: the World Bank's [2025 GovTech Maturity Index](#) records the country's digital transformation strategy as old and due for updating, with its successor only planned or in draft, and the cybersecurity strategy still in force is the expired [2021-2025 text](#) as at July 2026. Where a plan does exist it is an agency's rather than the state's: the universal-service agency published a 2026-2030 strategic plan on 11 August 2026 on [four pillars](#) — universal connectivity, digital services and financial inclusion, digital usage and literacy, and operational excellence — across ten projects, four funded at CFA 60.144bn through the national development plan and six from the agency's own funds, targeting [300 newly connected localities](#), smartphone penetration of 80% by 2028 against 40% now, and more than 15,000 km of new fibre by 2028, against a starting point at which 70% of rural households have no internet access. No adoption instrument for it is published.

The instrument being succeeded is the National Digital Development Strategy 2021-2025, organised around seven pillars including digital infrastructure and e-governance and reinforced by a "Digital Acceleration Zero Paper 2030" plan carrying a US\$600 million investment programme (2022), and its [paperless-administration target for 2030](#) is now the frame against which almost every other decision is justified. The successor was presented as Côte d'Ivoire Numérique 2030 at VivaTech in June 2025. Two further strategies, on artificial intelligence and on data governance to 2030, were handed to the Prime Minister on 13 March 2025 as a paired set; the AI text is public, carried in full through the OECD's AI policy repository. A seminar in April 2026 aligned the AI, cybersecurity, data-governance and zero-paper strands under the Ministry of Digital Transition, which also carries a 2026-2028 roadmap of seven axes sitting beneath the national digital strategy and the PND 2026-2030.

Delivery belongs to that ministry, which the GovTech index records as [an established institution with a whole-of-government mandate](#) (2025) and whose allocation rose to CFA83.2 billion in 2026 from CFA60.78 billion in 2025. The capacity to run what has been written is being assembled after the fact: in [May 2026](#) the ministry opened a call for six senior posts to implement the AI and data-governance strategies, among them three technical advisers, a director of information systems and directors for the digital transformation of the administration and for digital infrastructure. Sector plans now follow the centre: the Ministry of Economy, Planning and Development adopted a 2026-2030 information system master plan in December 2025, 44 projects budgeted at CFA10.156 billion, whose own diagnostic names regulatory gaps and legacy systems that do not interoperate.

Legislation and regulation

The legal base for electronic signature and trust services in Côte d'Ivoire is older than almost everything now built on it: the national public key infrastructure rests on [loi n°2013-546 of 30 July 2013 on electronic transactions](#), together with the [2014 and 2016 decrees on cryptology services, electronic signature and electronic archiving](#). The same 2013 package carries a [law on the fight against cybercrime alongside the transactions law](#), and [Law No. 2013-450 of 19 June 2013 on the protection of personal data](#), which adapts the ECOWAS Supplementary Act of 2010, grants rights of access, correction and erasure and requires consent for sensitive data including biometrics.

Since then the state has legislated mainly by ordinance and decree. [Ordonnance n°2017-500 of 2 August 2017 on electronic services](#) is in force, and the Council of Ministers of [18 June 2025 adopted a decree formalising the digital nationality certificate](#), which gave the electronically issued certificate a legal basis rather than launching a service. Identity is the clearest case of the pattern: [there is no single standalone digital identity law covering the full lifecycle](#), and the mandate for the biometric card is assembled instead from [identity-card statutes going back to 1962 and a series of later ordinances and decrees](#).

Where digital-specific law is silent, general law does the work. [Data-centre construction is caught by the environmental impact regime of Loi n°96-766 and Décret n°96-894](#), under which the Grand-Bassam project's impact study went to the Agence Nationale de l'Environnement for validation, and the framework for exchanging data between public bodies rests on [the 2013 data protection law read with the e-services ordinance](#). Payments law is barely national at all: the binding rules are regional, from [the WAEMU instruments governing electronic money to the central bank's interoperability deadline of 30 June 2026](#).

Data protection

Côte d'Ivoire's data protection authority is its telecoms regulator: [ARTCI receives complaints, conducts audits, imposes administrative penalties of up to CFA10 million, authorises sensitive data processing including biometrics and maintains a public register of processing operations, and issued an enforcement warning on workplace biometrics in June 2024](#) — the same body that regulates the operators it also supervises for data protection. The statute it enforces is [the 2013 personal data law](#), and on the World Bank's [2025 GovTech Maturity Index](#) the legislation is in force and assessed as effective, with a supervisory authority in place.

Where the regime is thinnest is exactly where the state is building fastest. [Law No. 2013-450 sets conditions on interconnecting personal data files](#) — that interconnection not discriminate, that security measures be used, that it be proportionate, with prior notification to or authorisation from ARTCI — but operational rules specific to sharing identity data between agencies are not codified (2024). Personal data may leave the country only after prior declaration to or authorisation from ARTCI, which keeps personal, biometric and health data domestic absent regulatory approval (2025). Meanwhile the state has financed surveillance across four cities, with Bank of China lending paying for [video surveillance and licence plate readers across Abidjan, Yamoussoukro, Bouaké, Odienné, Korhogo and San Pedro](#) and for a national emergency command centre with surveillance towers in cities across the country.

The measured position on rights has moved the wrong way while governance overall improved: [digital freedom fell 11.3 points over 2014-2023 to 62.6 out of 100, 22nd of 54 African states](#), and Personal Liberties is among the country's ten worst-scoring measures at 32.8 out of 100 and 35th of 54, down 10.1 points over the same decade.

Regional collaboration

The region's digital agenda is unfunded from within: the [ECOWAS Community MTEF Budget 2026-2028](#), which Côte d'Ivoire part-finances through the Community Levy, carries no disaggregated digital or ICT appropriation anywhere in its expenditure structure, and its one ICT-named programme line records nil actual spend from 2024

through the 2028 estimates, leaving the bloc's digital instruments dependent on external financing. The ECOWAS Digital Sector Development Strategy 2024-2029 was adopted at Cotonou on 4 October 2024, and the same meeting required every member state to have the ECOWAS Roaming Regulation fully implemented by all mobile operators by the end of 2025.

What crosses the border in practice runs on the central bank's rails rather than the Commission's. The BCEAO's interoperable instant payment system went live on 30 September 2025 with coverage still partial, interoperability becomes mandatory across the Union from 30 June 2026, and Côte d'Ivoire already leads the Union's cross-border electronic-money flows. Customs runs the one working regional data exchange, SIGMAT, live since 2019.

Identity is the opposite case. Côte d'Ivoire is a founding phase 1 member of the ECOWAS-World Bank WURI programme, whose cross-border interoperability strategy for mutual recognition of foundational credentials was validated in March 2026 and remains an objective rather than a service. The perimeter it would cover has shrunk: the 2024 withdrawal of Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger from ECOWAS took them out of WURI, and the three have since built a separate Alliance of Sahel States credential stack — a common AES biometric passport in January 2025, AES-aligned biometric national ID cards in Burkina Faso in November 2025 and Niger in March 2026.

Data moves across the bloc on a commercial logic that points away from the sovereignty framing: the Grand-Bassam data centre's developer makes its case on Abidjan being UEMOA's regional centre, under a regulatory regime letting banks and financial institutions store and move data freely across the Union, making it a regional disaster-recovery site. Membership has not yet added up to integration: the country scores 46.3 out of 100 on Regional Integration in 2023, 28th of 54 African states.

Standards

The tightest operating standard over Ivorian digital services is written by the regional central bank rather than in Abidjan: BCEAO Instruction No. 001-03-2021 requires payment service providers to report to the central bank within 24 hours any incident interrupting service for more than two hours, with a detailed report within three calendar days and penalties for non-compliance, while Instruction No. 001-01-2024 counts a breach compromising the confidentiality of information systems and data as a major operational incident.

The country does now have an interoperability layer: UXP, the commercial descendant of Estonia's X-Road, deployed by the state IT company SNDI and launched in September 2025. SNDI gives the platform's open-source character among its stated reasons for the choice and traces the decision to a national digital-governance roadmap drawn up in 2022 with the Estonian consultancy Digital Nation, on criteria of speed of deployment, proven security and alignment with the paperless-administration target. The constraint on making it bind is institutional rather than technical: the minister has called for clearer allocation of responsibility between ministries' information-system heads where one public service needs several agencies (July 2026).

Security and trust standards are further along than data standards. A general information systems security reference framework and a critical infrastructure protection plan are in force by decree, with a national CERT and regular security monitoring required of essential service operators, and ANSSI-CI has commissioned a national public key infrastructure as the sovereign root of trust for every certification authority operating on Ivorian territory. On identity, ONECI has joined the Secure Identity Alliance's OSIA initiative for open interoperability standards while the identity register, the health insurance database and the electoral register remain decoupled from one another, and harmonised technical specifications for national ID credentials across the region are a stated WURI objective for 2026. The regulator runs its own standards programme on the network side, pushing IPv6 adoption and making peering a recurring national exercise from a first forum in August 2025 to Peeringday 2026 in June 2026.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Côte d'Ivoire has no public e-participation platform and meets none of the six participation measures the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index tests (2025), the only family of measures in the index answered negatively throughout, even though it does run a citizen feedback mechanism for public services.

Expert assessments of how policy gets made are far kinder than the public's. Deliberative & Participatory Governance scores 73.6 out of 100 and 8th of 54 African states in 2023, essentially unchanged over the decade, while Public Perception of Political Participation fell 14.8 points to 44.7, 29th of 54. The same split runs through speech: Freedom of Expression & Belief rose 9.3 points to 77.2 out of 100 and 14th of 54, and Media Freedom fell 5.7 points to 69.3, still 8th of 54, while Ivorians' own confidence in free speech is among the ten most deteriorated measures, down 12.6 points to 37.2 out of 100 and 33rd of 54. The room to organise has narrowed from a comparatively open base, with Civil Society Space down 16.7 points to 62.4 and 20th of 54, one of the country's ten most deteriorated indicators, and Freedom of Association & Assembly unchanged at 50.0.

Consultation on individual projects is narrow: the public consultation for the Grand-Bassam data centre reached 12 of 15 identified stakeholders and drew opinions from seven (October 2022). Government tends to answer when challenged rather than as routine — the state IT company published a note defending the interoperability procurement after it drew public criticism, and what the public knows about the platform comes through ministerial and press announcements rather than any dashboard or transparency report on its governance and data-sharing agreements. Access to the records people would argue from has improved sharply from a low base, yet accountability and transparency remains the country's worst-scoring governance sub-category, flat over the decade.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

Côte d'Ivoire's digital agreements are with vendors rather than governments, and the furthest-reaching of them puts a foreign supplier inside national policymaking: under a July 2025 memorandum, the Emirati group G42 and its Presight arm are to help draft the country's next national artificial-intelligence strategy, alongside a non-binding memorandum of the same month on AI-driven modernisation of public services. Bahrain's Beyon Connect and La Poste de Côte d'Ivoire signed a memorandum in November 2025 for a OneID and OneBox proof of concept, putting a Gulf identity vendor into the postal and identity stack, and George Mason University and Cybastion hold a memorandum with the ministry covering artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity skills.

The domestic agreements run through operators already on the ground. Raxio Côte d'Ivoire and ARTCI signed a memorandum for Raxio's Grand-Bassam data centre to host CIVIX, the country's third internet exchange point, and Raxio has a second memorandum on data sovereignty, to host government workloads in its CIV1 facility. Orange Côte d'Ivoire and UNDP signed on 21 May 2026 to take digital skills and youth entrepreneurship beyond Abidjan, an education pact with French Tech Abidjan feeds some 75 firms into technical and vocational curricula, and Orange Bank Africa and the SGPME signed two partial portfolio-guarantee conventions on 23 July 2026 to widen small-enterprise credit.

New investments

The largest money committed to Côte d'Ivoire's digital estate is American, and none of it is evidenced as moving: the US Export-Import Bank-backed package Cybastion is authorised to deliver — a sovereign national data centre, a government digitisation platform, smart border surveillance — stood at USD 170 million in July 2026. It grew from a

USD 66 million data-centre guarantee approved in August 2025 and a USD 47 million commitment of 14 August 2025 for the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, consolidated under EXIM's China and Transformational Exports Program, whose stated purpose is countering the People's Republic of China.

Chinese lending is older, larger and largely spent. Two Bank of China agreements of 31 August 2018, CFA 53,267,282,421 and CFA 8,724,228,100, financed a Huawei contract for the education ministry's data centre and network, and were fully disbursed by September 2022. CFA 48,316,189,461 and CFA 7,948,624,543, signed 22 May 2019, put fibre and licence-plate cameras into six cities and were disbursed by mid-2021. A CFA 73,931,502,506 loan of April 2020 for a national emergency command centre and surveillance towers at 46 sites was 75 per cent disbursed at end-2022, and a CFA 72,678,277,635 loan for a third surveillance phase 66.4 per cent.

An IDA credit of FCFA 84,356,070,200 for phase 1 of the *Projet d'accélération digitale* was ratified by decree on 4 February 2026, the approved first phase of a USD 330 million World Bank envelope to 2035. The African Development Bank is putting UA 63,968,067 into e-government over 2023–2028, KfW e-governance with EUR 20 million to 2027, and the European Union grants of EUR 3.5 million to 2031 for private-sector support and EUR 1,715,000 to 2026.

Close to thirty commitments, over two dozen projects, are on record for 2018–2026, worth well over USD 1 billion, with windows running to 2031. Most are debt. Bank of China accounts for something near half of the country-specific total, ahead of the US Export-Import Bank and the World Bank; around a third of the money is approved rather than evidenced as moving. More of it funds state security and government administration than connectivity or inclusion.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Côte d'Ivoire's largest connectivity programme is not aimed at households. Its connectivity component is scoped to public facilities — schools, health centres, social centres, town halls, sub-prefectures, courts, post offices and regional directorates (February 2026), and the same programme counts its headline target of 648,572 people newly using broadband by 2030 as people inside institutions: 20,000 students attending school, 1,250 health-institution employees, 850 employees in city halls and sub-prefectures, 250 in tribunals (September 2025). Phase 1 is fenced to Abidjan, Yamoussoukro and twelve regions selected on poverty and low connectivity, with national expansion left to a Phase 2.

Beneath the mobile market there is almost nothing else: the regulator counted 178,047 fixed internet subscribers and 302,398 fixed telephone lines against 33,807,850 mobile subscribers (2018), and its own measurement put mobile coverage at 97% of the population but 83% of the territory, a fourteen-point gap population-weighted headlines hide. Reach is not use. 4G covered 91% of the population (2022) while 41% of individuals used the internet (2024), on international bandwidth of 47 kbit/s per user (2022), and the country levies the highest combined handset tax in Africa.

The satellite tier opened in 2026. The digital minister announced a 12-month provisional licence for Starlink alongside the launch of 5G (June 2026), after Orange began selling satellite broadband on Eutelsat KONNECT capacity into areas the terrestrial network does not reach (January 2026) and MTN struck its own Eutelsat deal for rural white areas (April 2026).

Where traffic goes is the regulator's current preoccupation. More than 33,000 km of fibre had been deployed by 2024, but one internet exchange point is active, with 13 to 14 members (2025); ARTCI has signed a memorandum with Raxio to host a third exchange, CIVIX, at Grand-Bassam (June 2025), convened a national peering forum (August 2025) and run Peeringday 2026 (June 2026). A consortium with Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea agreed in June 2026 to commercialise spare fibre on the TRANSCO CLSG power interconnector, a terrestrial cross-border route as redundancy against dependence on one submarine cable.

Data Storage

Commercial hosting capacity arrived ahead of the state's own. Raxio's CIV1 at Grand-Bassam opened in September 2024, Uptime Institute Tier III certified with 400 racks and 3MW of IT power, alongside carrier-neutral facilities operated in Abidjan by Equinix, PAIX and Atos; Cameroon's ST Digital opened a second Tier III building at Grand-Bassam in October 2025 with the French provider OVHcloud, presented at inauguration as the country's first sovereign data centre. No global hyperscale provider runs a region in the country, so enterprises needing hyperscale cloud connect to regions outside West Africa.

The government's own platform is still a building site. The National Data Centre at the VITIB technology zone in Grand-Bassam was just over 20% complete in December 2025, delivered by Cybastion with US EXIM backing and targeted for delivery at the end of 2026, construction of its sovereign core having begun in May 2025. EXIM approved a \$66m guarantee for it in August 2025, the first data centre the bank has backed anywhere in sub-Saharan Africa — 39.6bn FCFA in the government's own statement of the same money — with Cisco, HPE and Schneider as the equipment suppliers, and the scope had widened well beyond a data centre by July 2026.

What may be hosted abroad is decided case by case: personal data may leave the country only after prior declaration to, or authorisation from, ARTCI, which absent that approval keeps personal, biometric and health data on domestic infrastructure (2025). The draft cybersecurity strategy for 2026-2030 extends the state's scope to cloud for the first time.

Energy

Between a quarter and a third of Ivorians remain off the grid — 72.4% had access to electricity (2023) — and the firms that are connected reported around four electrical outages a month in the World Bank's 2023 enterprise survey. Access is nonetheless one of the faster-moving governance measures, up 14.4 points over 2014-2023 to 56.2 out of 100 and 15th of 54 African states (2023), and infrastructure as a whole is the second largest driver of the country's governance improvement, up 13.8 points to 59.3 and 11th of 54. Rural access lags urban access by a wide margin (2020).

Hydroelectricity supplies about 24% of generation (2023). Off-grid policy is the more developed part of the framework: the World Bank's RISE assessment records a comprehensive off-grid regime, with the rural electrification programme PDER providing subsidies and provision for private participation in mini-grid and solar hybrid deployment (2024). Coverage is near-universal on the ministry's own series and reliability is not: 8,690 localities were electrified at end-2024 against 3,887 in 2017, on a coverage rate of 94.3% and an access rate of 98.6%, while mean annual interruption time rose back to 26h13 in 2024 from 17h54 in 2021 against a 2030 target of under fifteen hours (2024).

What the grid means for hosting shows in how data centres are designed to survive it. The operating-phase environmental risks identified for the Grand-Bassam facility are generator fuel and lubricant spills, wastewater, NOx and VOC emissions, and water consumption — the risk list of a building expected to run on its own generators.

Technical Capacity

The state was still recruiting the people meant to run its digital agenda in 2026: the Ministry of Digital Transition opened a call on 26 May 2026 for six senior posts covering artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, legal regulation of the digital economy, information systems, digital transformation of the administration and digital infrastructure. Below the centre the depth thins quickly: subnational administrations are assessed as lacking the technical expertise to take part in the UXP exchange pilot, which involves national institutions only (2025), and the statistical system is the weakest part of an otherwise strong public administration (2023). The government's own public-sector digital skills provision is recorded as only partly in place (2025).

Operating expertise at the top of the private network is contracted out. Huawei has run Orange Côte d'Ivoire's network from a global network operations centre under a partnership now ten years old, covering more than twelve Orange subsidiaries and over 100 million customers (April 2026).

The domestic pipeline runs through the public *Ecole Supérieure Africaine des TIC* and a small set of private and international providers, and the organised developer community is concentrated in Abidjan around groups such as *Code d'Ivoire*.

Cybersecurity

Côte d'Ivoire has been governing its digital estate under an expired strategy. The text in force as at 23 July 2026 was still the 2021-2025 strategy adopted in December 2021, its successor a draft awaiting the Council of Ministers. ANSSI-CI put that draft to stakeholder review on 23 July 2026, on five axes — ethical governance and the legal framework, human capital and innovation, critical-infrastructure protection and cyber-resilience, the state's technical and operational capacity, and cooperation — extending the previous scope to artificial intelligence, emerging information technologies and cloud, and adding a monitoring and evaluation mechanism resting on performance indicators that the 2021-2025 text lacked. The draft is a déclinaison of the fifth pillar of the national digital development strategy.

The binding layer is older and more concrete. Decree No. 2021-916 brought the General Information Systems Security Reference Framework and a Critical Infrastructure Protection Plan into force, and the national response team CI-CERT operates alongside a requirement of regular security monitoring by essential service operators (2024). ANSSI-CI has commissioned a national public key infrastructure, the first sovereign root of trust for every certification authority operating on Ivorian territory (July 2026), named as underpinning electronic signature and the national digital identity. The country scored 78.95 out of 100 in the ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index 2024, in the index's "advancing" tier.

Some of the estate is defended commercially rather than by the state. Inbound international A2P messaging on Moov Africa's network — the channel one-time passcodes travel on — now runs through a firewall arrangement giving Omobio and the operator exclusive control of it (July 2026). Regionally, ECOWAS ministers adopted a directive on confidence-building measures in cyber and ICT which member states are to implement without delay on its publication (October 2024). Internet coverage expansion and cybersecurity are the two named spending priorities of the 2026 digital plan.

DPI

Data Exchange

Ten months after it was switched on, the government's data exchange is still a pilot of twelve institutions: the [Unified eXchange Platform](#) went live in Abidjan on 25 September 2025, built by Estonia's Cybernetica and implemented by the state IT company SNDI over a twenty-month project, and [its pilot phase still covered twelve public bodies in July 2026](#).

The contract is worth EUR 387,350, about FCFA 254 million, and buys three things: the platform core, the development of five priority services, and a transfer of skills to SNDI's teams and to the participating administrations. The state traces the choice of platform to a national digital-governance roadmap drawn up in 2022 with the Estonian consultancy Digital Nation, on stated criteria of speed of deployment, proven security and alignment with its paperless-administration target.

The pilot institutions include the identification office ONECI, the tax directorate and the social security fund CNPS. They do not include the education ministry, any passport or immigration authority, the electoral commission or the agriculture ministry, so none of those functions exchanges data through the platform, and the pilot reaches no subnational administration.

Most of what moves between Ivorian administrations moves outside it. The urban land platform SIGFU joins the tax directorate, the land registry, the cadastre and the urban planning administration. The tax directorate's own management system already interfaces with other administrations, and a December 2025 protocol sets up automated exchange with the single window for external trade. A labour market information system launched on 23 June 2026 pulls data from the social security fund, the civil service pension fund, the youth employment agency and the statistics agency, built to the SDMX exchange standard. A convention signed in April 2026 will interconnect the social registry with the national population register, the technical work still to come.

The responsible minister's account of the constraint is direct. The first services put onto the platform were chosen largely because agencies volunteered rather than against user priorities, and he has called for clearer allocation of responsibility between ministries' information-system heads where one public service needs several agencies.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Ivorians report that getting an identity document has become dramatically harder even as civil registration has improved: the perception measure fell 25.1 points over 2014-2023 to 33.2 out of 100 and 27th of 54 African states, the country's single most deteriorated governance indicator.

The biometric card is compulsory for citizens aged 16 and above, identity certificates may be issued to children between 5 and 15, and a national identification number is assigned at birth through the register of natural persons. The card cost 5,000 FCFA, about US\$8.40, against a poverty rate of 46%, with supporting documents and transport pushing the real cost well above the fee; civil society groups campaigned against it as exclusionary (2018). Applicants must first obtain a certificate of nationality from a Court of First Instance.

The register was created by decree in 2018, is managed by ONECI and serves as the reference database for other government systems, with nationwide enrolment still under way. There is no single law covering the digital identity lifecycle, and interconnection of personal data files falls under the general 2013 data protection law, which requires proportionality and prior authorisation from or notification to the regulator.

Holding the number buys access. ONECI now sells authentication against the register to commercial banks, Société Générale Côte d'Ivoire being the first; a valid identity document has been required to register a SIM card since 2011; and ONECI put the card on a phone with the myONECI+ application in April 2025. Legally resident foreigners are eligible for a biometric residence card, and asylum-seekers were approved for enrolment from 2025.

Civil registration underpins the whole structure: civil status records are by decree a designated source feeding the population register, and other administrations holding relevant personal data must transmit it to ONECI, and most civil status centres are now connected to the Cityweb software that records births, deaths and marriages electronically. The registration itself is going backwards. The share of births registered within the legal deadline fell from 66.8% in 2021 to 56.6% in 2023 and 55.4% in 2024.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Merchant acceptance more than doubled in a single year: registered merchants taking electronic payments rose from 1,131,590 in 2023 to 2,719,463 in 2024, growth the central bank attributes to QR codes.

Côte d'Ivoire is the union's largest electronic-money market. It carried 34.7% of WAEMU transaction value in 2024, up from 33.4% a year earlier and ahead of Senegal on 30.2%, while its share of transaction volume was 21.4%. It also leads cross-border flows, with about 33 million intra-union operations worth FCFA 1,924 billion in 2024, up 37.95%.

Account holding is measured far less often. 51% of adults held an account at a financial institution or with a mobile money provider in 2021, and an ARTCI household survey in 2017 found 41.94% of people held a mobile money account — 56.00% of men against 26.96% of women. Formal banking access is the country's lowest score on any of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators, at 21.4 out of 100 in 2023.

The state pays and collects on its own rail. A presidential decree of 8 May 2024 makes use of the Treasury's TrésorPay-TrésorMoney platform exclusive for non-tax revenue collection and mass public expenditure across all public administrations; it also processes salaries, student financial aid, tax collection and traffic fines, through an e-wallet with more than 6,000 distribution points. Deployment had reached 55% of the relevant public services in 2023, against a target of at least 90% for 2024. That wallet is not open money: a WAEMU treasury may issue electronic money only in a closed loop confined to beneficiaries of state allocations, and Côte d'Ivoire's is one of only two treasuries in the union that issues at all.

The BCEAO's instant payment system went live on 30 September 2025 with 45 connected institutions and several major banks staying out; and interoperability becomes mandatory across the union from 30 June 2026. Payment institutions must run a complaints mechanism and hold cover against losses from unauthorised access to account data. Agents at points of sale levy a charge of their own on deposits and withdrawals that no operator tariff provides for.

Registries

The electoral roll sits outside the state's identity infrastructure: the Independent Electoral Commission maintains its own biometric voter database, consultable only through its own website and SMS service, and has noted that it still relies on paper civil-status records rather than an automated feed. Registration covers roughly half the voting-age population.

There is no single nationwide digital address register. The Abidjan District Addressing Project has made standardised street names, building numbers and postal codes operational in several communes covering roughly 400,000 occupation units, a national digital address code was approved by the Council of Ministers in February 2025, extension is under way to Yamoussoukro, Korhogo and Daloa, and the database is shared with the tax authority, the statistics institute and utility operators.

Land is two registers at two speeds. Urban land runs on SIGFU, which centralises applications, parcel history and cadastral data under a unique parcel identifier and has used electronic signature for title deeds since January 2024, with coverage still short of nationwide. Rural land is at the beginning: the first electronic rural land certificates were signed in March 2026, in the Moronou region.

Business registration is joined up by design: registration at the companies register, the tax administration's taxpayer file, the social security fund and the external trade register happens simultaneously under a single shared identifier, processed by CEPICI. Just over 200,000 businesses hold it.

Formal business registration reaches under a fifth of the economic units the country counts.

The social registry had recorded more than 1.45 million households, covering 8.8 million individuals, by August 2025 against a target of more than 2 million over 2021-2025, and a convention signed in April 2026 is to interconnect it with the population register for unique identification and de-duplication, with the technical work still under development. Other registers stand alone: a database of driving licences and traffic offences that police can check in real time at the roadside since July 2025, an online mining cadastre, and civil status certificates requestable online through MonActe over records that are still largely paper, a pilot having digitised 200,000 at Grand-Bassam in 2024.

Sectoral management information systems

The education ministry's new management information system, launched in July 2025 with Millennium Challenge Corporation funding, covers 24 secondary schools in the Abidjan, Bouaké and San-Pedro regions. Beneath it, rural primary schools record attendance, enrolment and grades on paper and pass them up on physical questionnaires, a process the ministry's own strategy says causes delays, data-entry errors and administrative burden, and validation of the instruments for the sector's digitisation baseline study was completed only in December 2025.

Health is the same shape. The two main disease-surveillance tools, MAGPI and DHIS2, still depend on paper forms at facility level, and rural clinics keep paper registers and aggregate them monthly or quarterly into the national DHIS2 instance at district level rather than capturing anything at the point of care. Digital capture has reached some rural facilities through a health ministry platform launched in January 2025 with UNICEF support, equipping frontline workers with smartphones that record registration, antenatal follow-up and vaccination straight into DHIS2. A decree of July 2024 makes the health insurance registration number the mandatory unique health identifier across public and private facilities.

Revenue administration is the strongest function on the narrowest base. Budgetary and financial management scores 83.3 out of 100 and fourth of 54 African states in 2023, while the tax directorate put the entire taxpayer base across all non-property taxes at around 130,000 in the third quarter of 2021, roughly one taxpayer per 125 residents, a ratio it called low. A customs management system is in use on commercial off-the-shelf software, and the treasury system is used extensively by all ministries, departments and agencies.

The civil service runs human-resource and payroll systems, and a social insurance and pension system whose primary scheme also serves public employees. The agriculture ministry's October 2025 initiative with NEC — an e-voucher input distribution system and a farm database covering an initial 30,000 hectares — assigns biometric identifiers to registered farmers and runs as a standalone platform outside the government-wide exchange. Policing is centralised and urban, concentrated on Abidjan and the major towns and on central processing rather than capture at the facility.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Côte d'Ivoire now has a shortlist of what to build. A national prioritisation workshop closed on 4 September 2026 having examined 140 of 620 inventoried public services through nine working groups, retaining 59 for immediate priority and expecting ten quick wins by the end of 2026 — among them diploma authentication, digital proof of life for pensioners, the computerised patient record and a digital post box; the list itself is not published, and the minister put a governance framework for the digital transition ahead of it as the first priority, against ministries each building their own tools and platforms. The national public service portal is informational only, assessed at level 1 or 2 of the World Bank's online service maturity scale rather than as transactional, on the GovTech Maturity Index 2025 update.

What a citizen can actually transact sits on separate platforms, and the fastest-moving of them is justice. All 39 first-instance tribunals were connected to the e-Justice network on 30 June 2026, seventeen months after it opened as a two-court pilot at Dabou and Yopougon covering nationality certificates only; it authenticates users against ONECI's VERIF application. The certificate of nationality is issued online through the identite.ci portal under ONECI's visible electronic seal. The tax directorate's e-impots portal takes online declaration and payment, though it had registered only about 74,000 users by March 2022, and the tax administration launched an electronic taxpayer census in 2025.

La Poste launched MaPoste in January 2026, a digital mailbox backed by the national identification number and the population register that also delivers the identity card to the door. Drivers have been able to see their digital licence and their points balance on a phone since May 2026. A transport-flow platform for operators on the main corridors opened in April 2026, and Cybastion is building an enterprise resource planning system and a business-registration platform for the commerce ministry.

An electronic government procurement system is in use, covering online tendering and contract management. The frame around all of it is a paperless public administration by 2030, against which an inventory under the World-Bank-cofinanced PADCI programme mapped 232 public services across four categories and five priority sectors, and PADCI itself funds the creation and operationalisation of digital agencies and AI-governance frameworks alongside digital skills. What is missing is the return channel: none of the six e-participation measures the GovTech index tests is met.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Côte d'Ivoire's digital state stops at the national tier: the UXP data exchange pilot involves national institutions only, and sub-national administrations are assessed as lacking the technical expertise to take part (2025). What has reached the local level has arrived as connectivity and as national systems landing in local buildings, rather than as systems local government runs for itself: PADCI funds broadband to town halls, sub-prefectures and regional directorates, RAPID-CI counts its beneficiaries as the employees inside city halls, sub-prefectures, tribunals and social centres, and every first-instance tribunal was connected to the e-Justice network by 30 June 2026. Treasury payment digitalisation has begun to extend towards the collectivités territoriales (March 2026).

The registers a local administration would work from are Abidjan's. There is no single nationwide digital address register: the standardised system of street names, building numbers and postal codes is operational in Abidjan communes and is being extended to Yamoussoukro, Korhogo and Daloa, and the Grand Abidjan geoportal, the metropolitan geospatial and address platform, gained a promotion project under the smart-city programme in June 2026. The year's most concrete municipal initiative was Abidjan's too: the commune of Plateau launched a single shared underground duct network for all telecommunications operators (May 2026).

Rural digital data capture

Rural land is the one part of Côte d'Ivoire's rural record moving backwards: Rural Land & Water Access fell 20.8 points over 2014-2023 to 40.3 out of 100 and 39th of 54 African states, one of the country's ten most deteriorated governance measures, set against a rural economy scoring 72.5 and ranking 10th of 54 in 2023, led by rural market access at 85.0 and rural economy support at 83.0.

What is captured digitally at the rural front line is narrower than either score implies. Rural primary schools record attendance, enrolment and grades on paper and pass them to regional directorates as physical questionnaires, and rural clinics keep paper registers that are aggregated into the national DHIS2 system at district level rather than entered at the point of care. The exceptions are real and bounded. Civil status centres are very largely computerised on the Cityweb registry, so births, deaths and marriages move electronically instead of on paper between administrative levels; a smartphone scheme has put frontline health workers in one largely rural region directly into DHIS2; and the first electronic rural land certificates were signed in the Moronou region in March 2026, an early stage for a system created only in February 2025. Agricultural data has gone the other way: the agriculture ministry's e-voucher and farm database assigns biometric identifiers to registered farmers on a standalone ministry platform that is not linked to the government-wide UXP exchange.

The state's answer is to connect buildings. PADCI's connectivity component funds broadband to schools, health centres, town halls, sub-prefectures, courts, post offices and regional directorates, and not to households, while the World Bank's RAPID-CI is fenced in its first phase to Abidjan, Yamoussoukro and twelve regions selected on poverty and low connectivity, with national expansion left to a second phase. The reach into villages is left to programme and partnership: a digital-inclusion programme branded « Nos villages connectés » is extending connectivity to villages (July 2025), and Brastorne, which brings rural users online through low-bandwidth services, entered the country through a partnership with Orange (February 2026).

Technology

AI

The only artificial intelligence running in Ivorian public service delivery is a chatbot: EMY 101 answers citizens' administrative queries on WhatsApp and Messenger, and since March 2026 on a toll-free 101 line, giving civil-status and tax guidance and taking problem reports. The government's own data-exchange layer carries no analytics, data-quality or predictive capability of that kind.

The policy is far ahead of the practice, and says so itself. The National Artificial Intelligence Strategy adopted in 2025 and running to 2030 describes AI adoption within the public administration as embryonic, and treats fraud detection and data-quality tooling as future ambitions rather than existing capability. It is costed at 912bn FCFA across 15 objectives and 109 projects over five years (March 2025), and the package it belongs to provides for a sovereign cloud, a "Safe AI" label and a National Committee to steer implementation. It was presented to the private sector in May 2025, and the ministry is now recruiting the staff to implement it (May 2026).

The rules to govern any of it are still being bought rather than applied: PADCI's first phase funds technical assistance and equipment to create and make operational the country's digital agencies and its artificial-intelligence governance frameworks (February 2026). In the meantime the country's voice in AI governance abroad is carried by its telecoms regulator, ARTCI appearing for Côte d'Ivoire in Geneva in July 2026, and at the UN AI Governance Dialogue the same month it called for an African AI, by Africans, for Africans.

Compute exists in country, thinly: ST Digital launched NVIDIA GPU-based AI hosting serving Abidjan (February 2025), and the consultancy Artefact opened an Abidjan office in May 2025 and made it its Francophone Africa hub. Where the state has added AI capability itself, it has done so through staff rather than procurement: around twenty officials of the transport-fluidity observatory were trained at its Abidjan headquarters from 28 to 30 July 2026 to build their own AI assistants for their directorates' routine work, with the final day given to testing what they had built.

ICT Industry

The largest fiscal contribution from the Ivorian digital economy comes from a partly foreign-owned operator, not a state holding: Orange Côte d'Ivoire paid FCFA 110.3bn of the FCFA 169bn raised in 2023 from companies operating under public-service delegation. The state portfolio's technology, telecoms and post segment improved its net results by FCFA 10.5bn between 2022 and 2023, but the gain came from the trade-facilitation and administrative-systems side of it: GUCE CI, QUIPUX-Afrique, AIGF, SNDI and PCI added a cumulative FCFA 17.4bn in 2023, while Orange Côte d'Ivoire, ANSUT and VITIB SA fell by a cumulative FCFA 6.9bn.

The universal-service agency sits on the weaker side of that ledger: the seven non-commercial state bodies that include ANSUT saw net results fall by a cumulative FCFA 19.8bn in 2023. Regulation has moved the other way: business and competition rules are among the country's ten most improved governance measures, up 20.6 points over 2014-2023 to 57.8 out of 100 and 19th of 54 African states in 2023.

The domestic sector is concentrated in Abidjan and centred on fintech, agritech, e-commerce, logistics and edtech, with early-stage capital coming from international investors and development finance institutions rather than domestic venture funds. Abidjan has become a regional base for foreign platforms: Yango Group opened its continental headquarters there in 2025, its largest African office, and its largest local fleet owner GoCab had delivered 100 electric vehicles to driver-partners by July 2026, half of a 200-vehicle programme. Ivorian firms take some state work: Digital Afrique Telecom is the local partner on the public-administration interoperability platform, and the state has launched Tradepost, an e-commerce platform for traders (December 2025).

The physical base for the sector remains modest against its ambitions. At the VITIB free zone at Grand-Bassam, the first 180-hectare tranche of earthworks, roads and utilities is complete, the perimeter secured and the business hotel built and housing about ten firms (February 2025). A national Industry 4.0 strategy, developed with UNIDO and German funding, was handed to government in February 2025, and the ministry has set a target for raising the sector's share of GDP by 2030.

Innovation ecosystem

A startup law remains an announced intention rather than an enacted instrument (July 2025), and the state has gone on building the machinery it would have governed. The Ministry of Digital Transition launched two accelerator programmes in Abidjan on 29 July 2026 – Ivoire Tech Next 15, for 15 startups trading at least a year with a commercialised product, and Ivoire Tech Scale Up, for 15 digital SMEs averaging at least 500m FCFA of turnover, each cohort accompanied for 24 months, with applications closing on 13 September 2026. They sit alongside the Ivoire Tech Forum, the government's flagship convening for the startup economy, launched in July 2025, and a channel on which the state publishes its own digital-transformation projects for startups and SMEs to bid on.

Domestic financing has a visible anchor: the state-backed CDC-CI Capital has become the country's most active domestic startup investor, making regular seed-stage grants and equity or convertible investments including in Djamo, Julaya, ADES and Flot (2026). A technological innovation fund for startups was launched in July 2025. Debt has grown off a small base, Partech recording around US\$11 million raised by Ivorian startups in 2025, up 307% year on year.

A continental mapping counted 36 active innovation hubs in Côte d'Ivoire in 2021, putting it among the dozen or so African markets with 20 or more and ahead of most of Francophone West Africa, among them Impact Hub Abidjan, Jokkolabs and OVillage alongside the publicly backed Hub Ivoire Tech campus in the Plateau. The country nonetheless ranks 112th of 133 economies in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2024, and the newly handed-over national digital-fabrication laboratory at Cocody adds plant whose recurrent funding has not been set out.

Capacity

Literacy

Côte d'Ivoire has the teachers and not the results they are meant to produce: on the Ibrahim Index, human resources in education is among its ten best-scoring measures at 92.6 out of 100 and 11th of 54, up 8.8 points over the decade, while the index's education quality score sits at 40.7 and 30th of 54, up 2.7, and education completion at 43.1 and 22nd of 54 (2023). Staffing is not what holds the administration back, and a decade of gains in it has not moved what comes out the other end.

Education is the third worst-scoring of the country's governance sub-categories at 50.2 and 29th of 54, held down by enrolment at 33.6 — one of its ten worst-scoring indicators — and by equality in education at 41.6, both 36th of 54, though both have risen over the decade (2023). Whether children are in school at all, and which children, remains the weaker half of the picture.

The floor for using a digital system at all is lower still: the most recent nationally representative ICT household survey found 32.4% of individuals using a computer, 42.2% in urban areas against 21.9% in rural ones, and 38.3% of men against 26.2% of women (2017). Lower digital literacy is also one of the barriers that keeps women off the mobile internet, alongside social norms, handset affordability and not knowing what the internet is for, rather than any explicit bar on access.

The state's own view of its schools is being rebuilt rather than read off a running system. A Bank of China-financed digital education project for the education ministry was fully disbursed by 2022, yet the education management information system launched in July 2025 went live at pilot scope, and the technical validation of the instruments for the sector's digitisation baseline study was only completed in December 2025. Reaching households that French-language messaging does not is being handled the analogue way, by training announcers in local languages to relay civil-status and identification information (June 2026).

Training and skills

Almost everything that trains Ivorians in digital skills is somebody else's programme. What the state runs for its own officials reaches basic data science and data literacy and no further (2025).

PADCI's first phase funds advanced and intermediate digital skills training aimed at young people and women alongside the digitisation of public services in selected social sectors (February 2026). Around it sit partnerships: Orange Côte d'Ivoire and UNDP signed a memorandum on 21 May 2026 to take digital skills and youth entrepreneurship beyond Abidjan; an education pact with French Tech Abidjan, the PIETP, brings some 75 firms into technical and vocational curricula (June 2026); and the Cocody UniPod opens to students, graduates, artisans, start-ups and teacher-researchers, targets 50% women and states an intake from rural communities, covering prototype-to-enterprise work from fintech to agritech (August 2026).

The pipeline it all draws on is narrow at the top. Tertiary ICT teaching is anchored by the public École supérieure africaine des TIC, founded in 2012, with ISO 9001-certified training accredited by Cisco, Microsoft and Oracle and Franco-Ivorian double degrees, with private and international providers alongside it; the organised developer

community it feeds is concentrated in Abidjan around groups such as [Code d'Ivoire](#). That base performs: Ivorian students [won the Huawei ICT Competition world final in 2025](#) and were [sent to China again in 2026](#), making that a standing route for technical trainees.

Inside the administration the training is small and specific rather than programmatic: Estonia's Cybernetica, with Digital Afrique Telecom, [ran a 38-participant seminar for SNDI and administration staff on operating the interoperability platform](#) (July 2026), and around twenty staff of the transport-flow observatory [were trained over 28-30 July 2026 to build their own AI assistants](#). On absorption, a [World Bank youth employment and skills project](#) carries digital literacy and ICT training together with a digital job-matching platform, and the ministry itself [advertised six senior posts in May 2026](#) covering AI, cybersecurity and digital-economy regulation.

Research institutions

Côte d'Ivoire's first national digital-fabrication and innovation laboratory was [handed over by UNDP at the Lycée technique de Cocody in Abidjan, with the education ministry as contracting authority](#) (August 2026). It is a serious plant: 16 functional zones across five poles — mechanical and wood workshops, electronics and robotics, FabLab prototyping, agritech and greentech, and shared coworking — built to Fab Academy standards, with CNC machining, multi-material 3D printers, a laser cutter, drones, robots and 3D scanners, on roughly 100 kW of power.

What has not been published is how it will be kept running: [no operating timetable, operating budget or sustainment funding has been disclosed](#), which leaves the recurrent cost of a 100 kW machine shop inside a public lycée unaccounted for. That is the question to ask of every donated facility, and it is the one the handover did not answer.

The standing institutional base is thinner than the equipment suggests. The public [École supérieure africaine des TIC held ITU Centre of Excellence status from 2014 to 2022](#) and remains the anchor for advanced ICT work, and a [public AI university with associated centres of excellence is proposed](#) under the national development plan for 2026-2030 (June 2026).

Inclusion

Access to services

On 3 August 2026 the identity enrolment centre at Grand-Bassam was [running on a single agent handling intake, registration and card collection at once, and turned dozens of applicants away by mid-morning](#); the turn-aways there had been running for weeks. That counter is where the identity system meets the public, and Ivorians' own sense of how easily an identity document can be obtained has fallen further than on any other measure in the country's governance profile.

The pattern is wider than identity. [Côte d'Ivoire's inclusion and equality score has been flat across the decade at 54.4 out of 100, with equal socioeconomic opportunity strong at 73.2 but equal access to public services at only 51.9, 17th of 54 and down 1.5 points \(2023\)](#). The digital front door does not yet stand in for the counter: the national public service portal is informational rather than transactional on the World Bank's 2025 assessment, though the government assistant EMY 101 has answered civil-status and tax questions over WhatsApp, Messenger and a toll-free line since March 2026.

What keeps people off the online channel is price rather than absence. Only 13.46% of households had internet at home in 2017, and those without it named the price of the service (22.78%) and the cost of equipment (21.69%) far ahead of unavailability, at 1.67%. The device is taxed accordingly: Côte d'Ivoire levies the highest combined handset tax in Africa, at 50% (2025), even though a mobile broadband basket cost 2.4% of gross national income per capita in 2022, inside the region's affordability threshold.

Where the state does reach people it increasingly does so through a payment rather than a premises. More than 400,000 households received state cash transfers and accompanying measures between 2017 and 2024, and 33,881 asylum-seekers received unconditional monthly transfers in 2024, 142% more than the year before. Non-nationals are inside the system by design — the population register is open by decree to residents, visitors and refugees alike — but asylum-seekers still lacked the recognised identifier a mainstream payment account requires when their enrolment was approved for roll-out from 2025.

Digital divides

Women's access to public services in Côte d'Ivoire went backwards over the decade to 2023, falling 4.6 points to 46.0 out of 100 and 24th of 54 African states — one of the few declines inside a women's equality measure that otherwise rose 6.7 points over the same period.

The gender line runs through the devices themselves, and it widens at every step away from mere possession. Mobile phone ownership stood at 81.38% of men against 47.19% of women in 2017, a 34-point spread on 64.83% ownership nationally; actual use of a phone split wider still, 85.27% of men against 58.67% of women; and mobile-money use reached 37.07% of men against 16.08% of women, on 26.91% overall. Ivorian fieldwork puts the cause in social norms, weaker awareness of what the internet is for, the price of a smartphone and lower digital literacy rather than any explicit bar on women's access (2018).

Geography cuts as deep. Household computer ownership was 10.34% in urban areas against 0.28% in rural ones in 2017, a ratio of about thirty-seven to one, and phone ownership 74.67% against 54.36%. Internet use in 2026 remains more than twice as high in the towns as in the countryside, which is a use gap rather than a reach gap: mobile networks already covered nearly all Ivorians in 2018, if much less of the national territory. The electricity divide underneath it was wider than either (2020).

Beneath both lines sit schooling and registration. Education is among Côte d'Ivoire's weakest governance sub-categories, held down by enrolment and by equality in education (2023), and birth registration was markedly worse in the countryside than in the towns (2016) — so the people least likely to hold a device are also the least likely to hold the record that a digital service will ask them for.

Data

National statistics

The statistical system is the weakest part of an otherwise capable Ivorian state: it scored 44.2 out of 100 and ranked 32nd of 54 African states, up only 4.6 points across the decade, inside a public administration sub-category scoring 62.4 and ranking 13th (2023).

The weakness is not in the headline exercises. Population, agricultural and business censuses have all been run within the preceding ten years, and the enterprise and establishment census counted well over a million formal and informal economic units (2025), far more than the formally registered business base. It is the foundations that give way: the country scores above 89% on data use and 70-89% on data products, but 50-69% on data services and infrastructure and only 20-49% on data sources (2023) — the pillar covering censuses, surveys and administrative collection is the worst of the five. The survey programme is concentrated on households and labour, against two health surveys and one each for agriculture and business, leaving the productive side of the economy thinly measured (2023).

Administrative records cannot yet fill the gap. Rural primary schools record enrolment and grades on paper and pass them up through physical questionnaires (2025), rural clinics aggregate paper registers into the national DHIS2 at district level rather than capturing at the point of care, the main disease-surveillance tools depend on paper at facility level (2024), and civil registration remains largely paper-based beyond a digitisation pilot (2024), with on-time birth registration in decline.

Vital statistics are published: the annual civil-status yearbook comes from the Interior Ministry on UNICEF funding (2025). Three decrees on the National Statistical System — the statistical visa, the tariffing of statistical services, and the communication of administrative files — were adopted in the Council of Ministers on 18 June 2025, and a labour market information system built to the SDMX exchange standard launched on 23 June 2026. A publication duty does not guarantee a current series: the telecoms regulator publishes market statistics under article 82 of ordonnance 2012-293, and its Panorama, deposited with the ITU, carries 2018 market data and a household survey with 2017 fieldwork.

Open data

Côte d'Ivoire's record-transparency scores have risen sharply from a low base — disclosure of public records up 22.0 points over 2014-2023 to 50.2 out of 100 and 8th of 54 African states, accessibility of public records up 13.8 points to 40.1 and 17th — while the accountability and transparency sub-category they sit in stayed flat at 40.0 and 24th, the country's worst (2023).

The plumbing is in place. An open government data portal is running and publishing basic information and datasets (2025), a national data governance strategy to 2030 was handed to the Prime Minister on 13 March 2025 alongside the national AI strategy, and the state has an established institution with a whole-of-government digital mandate. Individual registers have gone further than the portal: the mining cadastre is online, built on Landfolio and aligned to EITI disclosure practice, publishing licence and permit information (September 2025), and a project to promote the Geoportail du Grand Abidjan, the metropolitan geospatial and address platform, was launched in June 2026.

What gets published well is what the macro-statistical machinery already produces. On the Open Data Inventory the strongest categories are balance of payments, government finance and health facilities at 7.5 out of 10, then prices and gender statistics at 7.0, while the weakest scored categories are energy and education outcomes at 4.5 and pollution and resource use at 5.0 (2024). Two categories — digital and communications, and food security — carry no score at all.

Across the 21 categories that carry a score the average is 6.0 out of 10 (2024), with economic data at 6.5 and social data at 6.1 against 5.2 for environmental data, the thinnest of the three domains.

Openness about the state's own systems is another matter. What is known about the interoperability platform at the centre of the government's data-sharing plans comes through ministerial and press announcements rather than routine reporting, with no public dashboard or transparency report on its governance or its data-sharing agreements (2025), and payment-system performance is reported annually rather than monthly or quarterly.

Use of satellite data

The nearest thing to a public geospatial platform is metropolitan rather than national: a project to promote the Geoportail du Grand Abidjan, the metropolitan geospatial and address platform, was launched in June 2026 as part of the Abidjan smart-city programme. In agriculture, a Huawei partnership to map agricultural plots, aimed partly at cocoa traceability under EU deforestation rules, was under examination in May 2026.

What has moved fast is satellite communications, which is a different capability. Orange sells satellite broadband over Eutelsat KONNECT capacity into rural areas the terrestrial network does not reach (January 2026), MTN followed with hybrid GEO and LEO KONNECT capacity for rural white areas (April 2026), and Starlink was given a 12-month provisional licence alongside the launch of 5G (June 2026). That is capacity to connect the territory, not capacity to observe it.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Côte d'Ivoire's first national data centre is being built by a Washington firm on United States export credit: construction at the VITIB technology zone in Grand-Bassam, delivered by Cybastion with US EXIM Bank backing, was under way in December 2025 with delivery targeted for end-2026, work having started in May 2025. The Export-Import Bank approved a guarantee for the centre in August 2025, the first data centre it has backed anywhere in sub-Saharan Africa, and had days earlier approved a second guarantee, on 14 August 2025, for the digitisation of a ministry's information systems, covering cybersecurity, cloud integration and administrative efficiency; the two were consolidated in September 2025 into a single guarantee issued under the United States' China and Transformational Exports Program. By July 2026 the package Cybastion had been formally authorised by the Ivorian government to deliver covered the data centre, a government digitisation platform and a smart border surveillance system, with Cisco as a technology partner, the build being supplied by United States vendors including Cisco, HPE and Schneider.

Commercial American infrastructure is older than the state programme: Equinix has owned and operated an Abidjan data centre and the Ivorian landing station of the MainOne submarine cable since April 2022, and Starlink was live in the country by 17 July 2026 after talks in March 2026 that put its market entry and tech-hub development on the bilateral agenda. In government systems, the education management information system launched in July 2025 with Millennium Challenge Corporation funding, and the state has held discussions with Visa, in May 2026, on postal financial services and startup financing. On skills, Cybastion's DigiEmpower programme is a five-year training commitment and a memorandum between George Mason University, Cybastion and the ministry covers artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity skills.

China activities

Chinese money in Côte d'Ivoire's digital estate has gone overwhelmingly into security systems. Bank of China loans signed in May 2019 financed phase two of the video surveillance platform, installing fibre and Huawei cameras with licence-plate readers in Abidjan, Yamoussoukro, Bouaké, Odienné, Korhogo and San Pedro and in April 2020 phase three, adding further cable, cameras and a traffic monitoring system using licence-plate readers, again implemented by Huawei. A separate loan of April 2020 financed phase two of the Ministry of Interior and Security's unified communication system — a two-floor national emergency command centre for police, military and fire services, surveillance towers at 46 locations in 22 cities and an integrated military IT network, contracted to China Railway Construction International Group. Two earlier buyer's credits, of September 2018 and March 2019, financed an integrated information system for the armed forces, recorded as completed on 31 December 2020, and two loan agreements of August 2018 financed phase one of the Digital Education Project against a Huawei commercial contract with the education ministry, funding a VoIP unified communication system, a dedicated data transmission network and a data centre for the ministry, fully disbursed by September 2022.

Chinese lending is the largest single source of external finance recorded for Côte d'Ivoire's digital estate, ahead of both the US Export-Import Bank and the World Bank.

Huawei's commercial position runs alongside the loan book: it has operated Orange Côte d'Ivoire's network from a global network operations centre under a partnership ten years old in April 2026, the government is engaging with it on a government super-app model for public administration (May 2026), and is examining a Huawei smart-agriculture partnership to map agricultural plots, aimed in part at cocoa traceability under EU deforestation rules (May 2026). The training route is the vendor's own competition: Ivorian students won the Huawei ICT Competition world final and were received in Abidjan in May 2025, and were sent to China again in May 2026.

EU activities

The layer government data exchange runs on is Estonian. The Unified eXchange Platform was launched in Abidjan on 25 September 2025, built by Estonia's Cybernetica and implemented by SNDI under a 20-month project, the product being the commercial descendant of Estonia's X-Road, and the state traces the choice to a national digital-governance roadmap drawn up in 2022 with the Estonian consultancy Digital Nation, on stated criteria of speed of deployment, proven security and alignment with the paperless-administration target. Skills transfer has begun: Cybernetica, with Digital Afrique Telecom, delivered a training seminar for SNDI and administration staff on running the platform in July 2026, and the government studied the Estonian model again at a Europe-East Africa digital public infrastructure session held in Estonia in May 2026.

European financing sits mainly on governance and small enterprise. KfW is financing a concessional loan running 2024-2027 to strengthen central e-governance structures, including rehabilitation and extension of the central state administrative network and the standardised digital processes behind online services. The European Union funds a private-sector programme running 2022-2031 that combines corporate social responsibility with digital initiatives and work on the legal and regulatory framework and « DigiGreen & Agri », running 2024-2026, on digital innovation for the low-carbon transition and youth employability. A national Industry 4.0 strategy was developed with UNIDO and German funding and handed to government in February 2025.

On infrastructure, the French cloud provider OVHcloud is a development partner in ST Digital's Grand-Bassam data centre (August 2025), and the Orange-led Via Africa submarine cable project, announced in May 2026, is planned to land in Côte d'Ivoire on an Atlantic route between Europe and West Africa. France is also where the country presents itself: the national strategy Côte d'Ivoire Numérique 2030 was presented at VivaTech in June 2025, a startup delegation returned to VivaTech 2026, and the country took part in the Paris AI Action Summit in February 2025.

Gulf/UAE activities

A foreign vendor is helping write Côte d'Ivoire's next national artificial-intelligence strategy: one of two memoranda signed with the UAE's G42 and Presight in July 2025 has the company assist in drafting it, the other, non-binding, covering AI-driven modernisation of public services. Bahrain's Beyon Connect and La Poste de Côte d'Ivoire then signed a memorandum in November 2025 for a OneID and OneBox proof of concept, putting a Gulf digital-identity vendor into the identity and postal stack. The one Gulf commitment with money behind it is the Islamic Development Bank's, financing digital transformation and health security in healthcare services through 2029, developing health information systems and digital health platforms in support of the National Health Development Plan.

India activities

India's only recorded involvement is as a prospective lender: the Grand-Bassam technology zone VITIB was, in April 2025, seeking finance from Indian investors and the Export-Import Bank of India for its development plan to 2028. No Indian-built system, bilateral digital agreement or training programme was on record as at August 2026.

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